

Undone, diminished and lost to the world that her daughter still walks in. While a Kinain cannot actually lose her connection to the Dreaming, if all of the changelings she knows fade away into the Mists, she might find herself cut off from the magic in her family just the same.

Kinain, Past and Present

Fairy tales and folklore frequently tell of human beings swept away for a night of passion with a mysterious, supernatural stranger. These early stories suggest the Kinain were a happy accident. The first travelers to Earth from the Deep Dreaming had no idea that their trysts with mortals could bear anything but other mortals. Unsure of what to do with their fae-blooded offspring at first, a great many Kinain perished simply by their parents' attempts to bring them home to Arcadia with them. Eventually, the ancestors puzzled out the "rules" of Kinain existence, and saw the use that would define their place in faerie society: the intermediary, the go-between for things too banal to bear and the fae, dreams brought to life and every bit as fragile as changelings today are.

Primitive man had a habit of pointing at anything supernatural and calling it a god, and who's to say they were wrong? Before the Shattering, the fae *were* as gods to the mundane world, and the children that shared their power inspiration for demigods, cultural heroes, and possibly a few devils and angels. In short, it was a good time to be Kinain.

After Banality took hold of the world and refused to let go, Kinain, with their immunity to the long-term effects of Banality, became trusted vassals of the Kithain. Since freeholds had to separate themselves to a greater degree from mortal society for their own protection, Kinain played the necessary roles of go-betweens for the fae and humanity.

This is how it was for centuries, until the Resurgence opened the doors of Arcadia, letting the sidhe back and forever changing the landscape of Kithain society. The sidhe expected Kinain to continue in their servile roles, with the proper deference to their "betters," but the Kinain, like the commoner kiths who remained on Earth, had seen the rise of egalitarian societies and struggles for equal rights. They were not interested in pledging service to recently returned nobles (especially since most Kinain at the time weren't related to any sidhe, except for the odd child of a Scathach refugee). The Accordance War remained a conflict among changelings, but Kinain occasionally served as scouts, couriers, and even warriors in desperate situations. Once the war ended, the Dreaming attempted to right itself and nobles claimed their titles and their territories... but the Kinain have no particular place in changeling society.

In many ways, it's much better than they've had it in a long time. Some freeholds might take after their abusive forebears, while some might stick to the traditional method of trusted buffers between the more banal aspects of life and those who are at risk of being Undone. Some simply judge individual fae-blooded on their own merits, letting what they can accomplish for their family, motley, and court decide what sort of treatment they might receive at the hands of the capricious and all-too-often callous lords of Faerie.

Conception to Early Childhood

Like their changeling parents, Kinain appear to have completely normal human biology. The secret to magic, as ever, is in the soul. Shortly after birth, the child drew some of the Kithain parent or parents' magic into itself, planting a seed of supernatural potential waiting to blossom or wilt.

All of that assumes only one parent is Kithain. No matter what combination of mother and father (as long as at least one of them is some measure of fae), the chances of the resulting child's chances of being Kinain can't be predicted. Further confusing matters, the potential to store Glamour can skip a generation, or even multiple generations. There really is no explanation for why some children are Kinain and some aren't, beyond the whims of the Dreaming itself.

Once the magic takes hold, Kinain can be identified immediately by the wellspring of Glamour released as the newborn's magical heritage asserts itself. With this comes a full view of the world, mundane and chimerical, the problems of which are self-evident as soon as the baby starts crying at nightmare creatures or chasing chimera. If a changeling parent is still in the picture and enchantment is either problematic or impossible, the next five or six years of her life will be a campaign of deception leveled against her partner that their child simply has a very active imagination, and convincing him that she is in no need of psychiatric help.

The mundane world's taboo on seeking mental health treatment, for once, works in somebody's favor. A nonsensical prejudice that ruins countless mundane lives can give the parent of a Kinain an excuse to avoid therapy and medication until the child is old enough to understand what she can and can't tell people she sees and hears, and why it's so important. Whether such an explanation sticks or not is entirely in the hands of the child, unfortunately.

Dauntain-blooded?

Unfortunately, being Dauntain does not preclude one from possibly having a Kinain child. While the cursed mark doesn't transfer from parent to child, misery loves company and particularly twisted Dauntain will spare no expense driving a child with even a spark of the fae down their dark paths.

The Kithain look at this with as much disgust and terror as any mundane individual would, perhaps even more. Some freeholds go so far as to kidnap the child and try to undo the damage as best they can. Others with connections to the mundane world strong enough may simply contact the local authorities. Abuse is abuse, after all, and with the right cantrips, it would be simple enough to place the child with a foster family of Kinain, or even changelings. That does raise the question of what to do when the Kinain's Dauntain parent comes calling, of course.